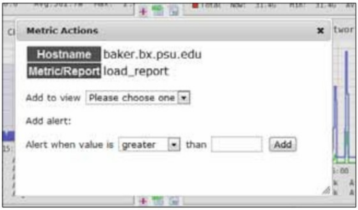

Figure 5: Views

for many years without much change to the UI—but since October 2010, a few contributors began contributing to a new UI, which looks awesome (see Figure 3). Let's briefly look at the six different options (tabs):

- **Main:** This shows the summarised form of how the grid and each cluster are behaving. You can then select individual clusters from the drop-down menu, to view how the various nodes under it are performing.
- **Search:** This awesome new feature wasn't available in the previous interface. It lets you search for metrics or hosts (see Figure 4). It will show results as you type; clicking on the selected result will take you to a new window.
- **Views:** At times, you need to see a different set of metrics from different sources on a single page. To achieve this, use views (see Figure 5), which are nothing but JSON files; each view has one JSON file, with a configuration like the following, which would show *cpu_report* and *apache_report* from both hosts:

```
{"view_name":"default",
  "items":[
    {"hostname":"host1.bx.ps.edu","graph":"cpu_report"},
    {"hostname":"host2.bx.ps.edu","graph":"apache_report"}
  ],
  "view_type":"standard"
}
```

Another cool aspect about this is that you don't need to write code for it; you could simply do this via the GUI, by clicking the (+) option on the top right corner and selecting the view that you want added in this metric.

- **Aggregate graphs:** This option lets you aggregate two or more hosts over a common metric—very useful to look for bottlenecks in your infrastructure. Graphs can be of the line or stacked variety (see Figure 6).
- **Automatic rotation:** This lets you set your views to automatic rotation; you can view different metrics in a view, one by one, like slides—very useful for continuous monitoring over dashboards. Also, you can open multiple views simultaneously on different browsers, and set the rotation time in seconds.

Figure 6: Aggregate graphs

- **Mobile views:** This lets you monitor your infrastructure over the mobile. It looks pretty neat and clean on the mobile screen.
- **Time range:** You can view performance for the last two hours, four hours, the last day, week, month, year or any custom time range you define.

Custom metrics

Ganglia comes in with a lot of metrics, by default, like various CPU, network I/O and memory metrics. But there is certainly a need to trend and monitor a lot more data, like Apache statistics, Memcache evictions, Java performance, and to track the effect of releases on servers, users, etc. This can be done by writing your own modules that run with gmond, or use the command *gmetric* that comes with the Ganglia set-up. Both have their own advantages and use cases.

These are just a few points. What makes Ganglia so attractive is how easy it is to trend your data. Once you have your set-up up and running, you will really like the way it works. And this is not the end; its integration with Nagios is really going to help, because then you have the power to set alerts on trending data. END

References

- Ganglia Info: *http://ganglia.info*
- Source code repos: *https://github.com/vvuksan/ganglia-misc*
- People to follow: *@vvuksan, @gangliainfo*

By: Konark K Modi

The author is a systems developer for website operations at Makemytrip.com, and a technology enthusiast at heart. Follow him on Twitter: *@konarkmodi.*